

Vancouver City Council — Regular Council, March 31, 2026

TL;DR

- Council gave **approval in principle** to the major **Heather Lands** rezoning (MST/Canada Lands), a multi-phased mixed-use development of ~317,861 m² (3.4M sq ft) in buildings of 4 to 46 storeys across two new CD-1 districts, after referring debate from the March 5 Public Hearing.
- Council **enacted the Vancouver Official Development Plan (By-law No. 14660)** and, by administrative motion, **rescinded the 2022 Vancouver Plan** and adopted consequential amendments to dozens of area plans and rezoning policies — a sweeping reset of the city's land-use framework.
- 16 by-laws were enacted, including the new ODP, two ODP repeals (Regional Context Statement and Greenhouse Gas Emission Reduction), three housing-agreement by-laws, and several CD-1/Sign/Noise amendments.
- Council redirected **SRO grant funding** (\$899,753 + \$500,000) to the **Empty Homes Tax** as the source rather than the original capital budgets, while preserving existing allocation streams.
- Ten Council Members' Motions were filed for referral to upcoming committee meetings (Apr 22 CFSC and May 6 PSPC).

Key Decisions & Votes

Item	Outcome	Notes
In-camera authorization (Vancouver Charter s.165.2)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY	Moved Dominato / Klassen
Adoption of 8 sets of prior minutes (Public Hearings + Council)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY	Consent-sty adoptions
Vary agenda to take By-laws after Unfinished Business	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY + required majority	Moved Dominato / Meiszner

Heather Lands CD-1 rezoning (Unfinished Business 1) — approval in principle, parts A–I	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11481)	Kirby-Yung, Meiszner, Montague abstained. A referral to in-camera was moved then withdrawn. Meeting extended past noon to finish.
Villages Planning Program ODP consultation (Report 2)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY as amended (Vote 11486)	Bligh amendment to add "business improvement associations" CARRIED (11484); Orr amendment to add tenant/comm organization LOST (11485)

SRO Upgrading & Cooling/Warming Retrofit Grants (Report 3)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY as amended (Vote 11489), A/B/D by required majority	Funding source changed to Empty Homes Tax (see Money section). Seven public speakers in support.
Green & Inclusive Community Buildings funding application (Report 4)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11490)	Klassen absent for vote
Front-ender Agreement Amendment (Report 5)	ADOPTED ON CONSENT (Vote 11482)	
Brewery Lounges resolution (Report 6)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11491)	Extends enforcement suspension 2 more years
CD-1 (363) Text Amendment, Canada Place floating hotel — refer to Public Hearing	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11492)	
Enactment of By-law 14 (Vancouver ODP, #14660)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY	Montague ineligible; Meiszner, Orr, Mayor Sim absent for vote

Enactment of By-laws 1–13, 15, 16	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY	Various councillors ineligible on specific sign/noise items
Regulatory Changes re ODP — rescind 2022 Vancouver Plan + consequential amendments (Admin Motion 1)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11495)	Klassen absent
		Cancels Apr 16 &
2026 Council meeting schedule changes (Communications 1)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11493)	May 7 Public Hearings; reschedules Budget Task Force oversight
Leaves of absence (New Business 1)	CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY (Vote 11496)	

Bylaws & Policies Enacted or Discussed

The 16 by-laws enacted at this meeting (grounded in the by-law texts in the repo):

- **By-law No. 14660 — Vancouver Official Development Plan (adopted).** Adopts the city-wide ODP after referral to Metro Vancouver and consideration of provincial transit-oriented-area guidelines and the city's financial/capital-planning documents. This is the centrepiece: it replaces the 2022 Vancouver Plan as the governing land-use document.
- **By-law No. 14661 — repeals the Regional Context Statement ODP By-law No. 10789, and By-law No. 14662 — repeals the Greenhouse Gas Emission Reduction ODP By-law No. 10041,** both consequential to the new ODP.
- **By-law No. 14647 — amends Zoning and Development By-law No. 3575** to rezone 414–420 West Pender Street to CD-1 (amends the Zoning District Plan / Schedule D).
- **By-law No. 14648 — amends the Street and Traffic By-law No. 2849,** adding a new s.84(3) prohibiting owners/occupiers from causing or allowing rubbish, debris, or discarded materials to be deposited on the street.

- **By-law No. 14649** — amends the **Ticket Offences By-law No. 9360** to align ticketing with the Street and Traffic By-law and the Solid Waste By-law.
- **By-laws No. 14650, 14651, 14652** — **Housing Agreement by-laws** for 5889–5925 Dunbar Street, 6055 Fraser Street, and 5238–5262 Granville Street / 1495 West 37th Avenue respectively.
- **By-laws No. 14653, 14655, 14657** — **amend the Sign By-law No. 11879**; **By-laws No. 14654, 14656, 14658** — **amend the Noise Control By-law No. 6555**, paired to specific development sites (800 Commercial Drive; 2096 West Broadway/2560–2576 Arbutus; 450–496 Prior/550 Malkin/1002 Station).
- **By-law No. 14659** — amends the **Subdivision By-law No. 5208** (1110–1160 West King Edward Avenue).
- The **Zoning and Development By-law No. 3575** itself is referenced repeatedly but is a ~170 MB consolidated document that exceeds the repository's file-size limit; it is recorded as an external reference rather than stored.

Money & Budget Items

- **SRO Upgrading Grants: \$899,753** (three grants) and **SRO Cooling/Warming Retrofit: \$500,000** (Downtown Eastside SRO Collaborative Society, for 6 privately-owned SRO buildings). Council **amended the funding source from the 2026 SRO Upgrading Grant Capital Budget / 2026–2028 retrofit budget to the Empty Homes Tax (EHT)**, "while maintaining the SRO Upgrading Grants and Emerging Climate Adaptation Priorities allocation streams intact."
- **Green & Inclusive Community Buildings application: \$2,359,000** sought from the Government of Canada for the Champlain Heights Community Centre Energy Retrofit (total project cost **\$2,948,750**); related adjustments to the 2023–2026 Capital Plan approved subject to a contribution agreement.
- **Front-ender Agreement** with Pennyfarthing Properties Ash St. North Ltd. modified to an **upset limit of \$1,211,720** (incl. taxes), paid from the Utilities Development Cost Levy reserve fund over 10 years.

Contentious Items & Public Delegations

- **Heather Lands rezoning** was the most procedurally fraught item: debate was referred from the March 5 Public Hearing as Unfinished Business, a motion to refer it to an in-camera meeting was moved and then **withdrawn**, Council suspended its speaking-time rules twice (Procedure By-law s.8.8), recessed multiple times, and extended the meeting past noon. It ultimately carried unanimously with three abstentions.
- **SRO grants** drew **seven public speakers, all in support** of the recommendations; the live debate centred on switching the funding source to the Empty Homes Tax.
- On the **Villages Planning Program**, Councillor Orr's amendment to explicitly add tenant organizations and community housing organizations / land trusts to the consultation list was **defeated** (Bligh, Klassen, Maloney, Montague opposed), while a narrower amendment adding business improvement associations passed.
- Enquiries flagged ongoing concerns: **FIFA World Cup 2026 traffic impacts**, and **sex worker safety / MMIWG / gender-safety integration with FIFA** (City Manager to follow up). The Mayor noted

condolences for Musqueam elder Howard Grant.

What to Watch Next

- **Ten Council Members' Motions** were filed for placement on the **April 22, 2026 City Finance & Services** agenda (major sports initiative; 2027–2030 Capital Plan strategic priorities; Holodomor memorial; FCM board renewal; provincial housing funding vs. targets; vehicle-shelter penalties during FIFA; International Day of Older Persons) and the **May 6, 2026 Policy & Strategic Priorities** agenda (eco-corridor stewardship; compact community-serving zero-waste options; small rapid shelter systems).
- **CD-1 (363) Canada Place floating-hotel** text amendment now heads to a **Public Hearing**.
- Schedule changes: the **April 16 and May 7 Public Hearings were cancelled** (converted to Meeting Reserves), the April 21 Court of Revision was cancelled, and the Mayor's Budget Task Force Implementation Oversight Committee moved to **July 6, 2026**.
- Watch for **enactment of the Heather Lands CD-1 and associated Housing Agreement by-laws**, which were only approved in principle and depend on further legal drafting.